JanGyan — Learn Without Limits

Category 2: Government Services & Citizen Rights

Module 7 - Emergency & Public Support

Module Overview

This handbook is your complete, beginner-to-advanced guide to **Emergency & Public Support Services** — covering the National Emergency Number, Police, Ambulance, and Fire Services, the Women's and Child Helplines, Disaster Helplines, Cyber Crime Reporting, and Public Grievance Helplines. In a genuine emergency, hesitation costs time — this module ensures you never have to search for the right number when it matters most.

By the end of this module, you will not need to search anywhere else to know exactly which number to call for any emergency or grievance in India.

Learning Objectives

After completing this module, you will be able to:

- Use India's unified emergency number 112 confidently and correctly
- Identify which helpline applies to police, medical, fire, women's, and child safety emergencies
- Understand India's disaster management helpline structure
- Know how to report a cybercrime and file a public grievance
- Use the 112 India App's panic and SHOUT features
- Guide family members, especially children and seniors, on emergency numbers

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Why This Topic Matters

India's **Emergency Response Support System (ERSS-112)**, launched on 19 February 2019, unified police (100), fire (101), and women's (1090) helplines into a single, internationally recognised number — **112** — now operational across all States and Union Territories. Meanwhile, the **CPGRAMS** public grievance portal redressed an all-time high of **26.46 lakh grievances in 2024** alone, and over **1.15 crore grievances** between 2019 and 2024.

> *Reality Check: In a genuine emergency, every extra minute spent trying to remember or search for the correct helpline number can matter. Yet many citizens still don't know that a single number — 112 — now covers police, fire, medical, and women's safety emergencies nationwide.*

Knowing these numbers isn't just convenient — in a real emergency, it can be the factor that determines how quickly help arrives.

Introduction

India's emergency and public support ecosystem operates at two levels:

- **Emergency Services:** Immediate, urgent response for police, medical, fire, women's safety, child protection, and disaster situations — primarily unified under **112**
- **Grievance & Reporting Services:** Non-immediate but important channels for reporting cybercrime (1930) and lodging formal grievances against government services (CPGRAMS)

This module covers both, so you know exactly which channel to use in any situation — urgent or otherwise.

Fundamental Concepts

Emergency Numbers at a Glance

Number	Purpose
112	Unified national emergency number (police, fire, medical, women's safety, disaster)
100	Police (now integrated into 112)
101	Fire (now integrated into 112)
108 / 102	Ambulance/medical emergency (varies by state)
1090 / 181	Women's helplines
1098	Child helpline (CHILDLINE)
1930	Cybercrime/financial fraud helpline

Emergency vs Grievance: Knowing the Difference

Situation Type	Right Channel
Immediate danger or crisis	112 (or the specific emergency number)
Financial cyber fraud	1930 / cybercrime.gov.in
Dissatisfaction with a government service	CPGRAMS (pgportal.gov.in)

Complete Detailed Explanation

Part A — National Emergency Number (112)

Definition: A Pan-India, single emergency number unifying police, fire, medical, women's safety, and disaster response services, launched by the Ministry of Home Affairs on 19 February 2019.

How it works: Calls, SMS, panic signals, emails, and web requests are received at a state-level **Public Safety Answering Point (PSAP)** and dispatched to the relevant service (police/fire/health/disaster). The **112 India App** includes a **SHOUT** feature, alerting nearby registered volunteers and other 112 App users in addition to authorities.

Panic Trigger: On smartphones, pressing the power button three times quickly (or long-pressing 5/9 on basic phones) sends a panic signal with location data to the Emergency Response Centre.

Part B — Police Services

Police emergencies (theft, assault, immediate danger, disturbances) are handled through **112** (or the legacy 100 number, still functional in many areas). Police is a State List subject, so response is coordinated through state police departments.

Part C — Ambulance Services

Medical emergencies are handled via **108** (advanced life support ambulance, available in most states) or **102** (basic patient transport in some states), both now also reachable through **112**.

Part D — Fire Services

Fire emergencies are handled via **101** (or 112), with state Fire & Emergency Services departments coordinating response and rescue operations.

Part E — Women Helpline

1091 and **181** are dedicated women's helplines for harassment, domestic violence, and safety concerns, complementing 112's women's safety dispatch capability and the 112 App's SHOUT feature.

Part F — Child Helpline

1098 (CHILDLINE) is India's dedicated 24×7 helpline for children in distress, abuse, or need of protection, connecting callers to child protection services and, where necessary, police or medical support.

Part G — Disaster Helplines

The **National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA)** coordinates disaster response nationally, while state disaster management authorities operate their own helplines during floods, cyclones, earthquakes, and other emergencies — all also reachable through 112's disaster dispatch function.

Part H — Cyber Crime Reporting

As detailed in JanGyan's Cyber Safety category, **1930** is India's dedicated financial cyber fraud helpline, and the **National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal** (cybercrime.gov.in) handles all categories of cybercrime complaints, including crimes against women and children online.

Part I — Public Grievance Helplines

CPGRAMS (Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System), run by the Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG), is a 24×7 online platform connecting citizens to every central ministry/department and participating state government for service-related grievances — completely free of charge, with resolution guidelines targeting **21 days**.

Important Terminologies

Term	Simple Meaning
ERSS	Emergency Response Support System, India's unified 112 emergency framework
PSAP	Public Safety Answering Point, the state-level facility handling 112 calls
SHOUT	A 112 App feature alerting nearby volunteers/users during an emergency
NDMA	National Disaster Management Authority
CPGRAMS	Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System
DARPG	Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances
CHILDLINE	India's 24×7 child helpline, reachable at 1098

Step-by-Step Understanding

How to Use 112 in an Emergency

1. Dial 112, or press the phone's power button three times quickly for a panic signal
2. State your location and the nature of the emergency clearly
3. Stay on the line if safe to do so, providing further details as requested
4. If using the 112 India App, use the SHOUT feature to alert nearby help simultaneously
5. Follow any instructions given by the dispatcher until help arrives

How to File a Grievance on CPGRAMS

1. Visit pgportal.gov.in or open the CPGRAMS app / UMANG integration
2. Register/log in and select the relevant Ministry/Department or State
3. Describe your grievance clearly, attaching supporting documents if needed
4. Submit and note your unique registration ID for tracking
5. If unsatisfied with the resolution, use the appeal facility within CPGRAMS

Real-Life Indian Examples

(Widely reported public initiatives, described for educational awareness.)

- **112 Nationwide Rollout:** Starting with a launch across several states in 2019, ERSS-112 expanded to become operational across all States and Union Territories, unifying what were previously separate police, fire, and women's helpline numbers.
- **CPGRAMS Record Year:** 2024 saw an all-time high of 26.46 lakh grievances redressed on CPGRAMS, with over 1.03 lakh Grievance Redressal Officers mapped across the system to handle citizen complaints.
- **CHILDLINE Interventions:** India's 1098 helpline has long served as a critical first point of contact connecting children in distress to protective services across the country.

Practical Scenarios

Scenario 1: You witness a road accident and need to call for both police and an ambulance.
Dial 112 — a single call can dispatch both police and medical emergency response.

Scenario 2: A child in your neighbourhood appears to be in distress or unsafe.
Call 1098 (CHILDLINE) to connect with child protection services immediately.

Scenario 3: You've filed a complaint with a government department weeks ago with no response.
File or escalate the issue formally through CPGRAMS (pgportal.gov.in), which provides a trackable registration ID.

Scenario 4: Your area is experiencing severe flooding and you need official disaster assistance.
Call 112 or your state's disaster management helpline, both linked to NDMA-coordinated response.

Government Rules / Guidelines

- **Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA):** Operates ERSS-112 nationally, in partnership with State/UT governments.
- **National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA):** Coordinates national disaster response and state-level disaster helplines.
- **Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG):** Operates CPGRAMS for public grievance redressal.
- **Ministry of Women and Child Development:** Oversees women's and child helpline frameworks (181/1091, 1098).

Laws & Policies

Law / Provision	What It Covers
Disaster Management Act, 2005	Establishes NDMA and the national disaster response framework
CPGRAMS Guidelines (2024)	Sets grievance redressal timelines (21 days) and appeal mechanisms
IT Act, 2000 — Sections 66C, 66D	Relevant to cybercrime reporting via 1930/cybercrime.gov.in

Important Statistics

Metric	Figure
ERSS-112 launch date	19 February 2019
States/UTs with ERSS-112 operational	All States and Union Territories
CPGRAMS grievances redressed (2024)	26,45,869 (all-time high)
CPGRAMS grievances redressed (2019–2024)	Over 1.15 crore
Grievance Redressal Officers mapped on CPGRAMS	1,03,675
CPGRAMS target resolution timeline	21 days
Cybercrime helpline	1930 (24×7, toll-free)
Child helpline	1098 (24×7)

(Figures are approximate, drawn from MHA, DARPG, and PIB publications through 2025–2026.)

Best Practices

- Save 112, 1930, 1098, and 181 in your phone contacts in advance
- Install the 112 India App and familiarise yourself with its panic and SHOUT features
- Use CPGRAMS for formal, trackable grievances rather than informal complaints alone
- Teach children and senior family members the panic button/power-button trick for 112
- Keep your exact address/location details ready to share quickly during an emergency call

Common Mistakes

- Not knowing that 112 now covers police, fire, and medical emergencies in one number
- Wasting time searching for department-specific numbers during a genuine emergency
- Assuming a CPGRAMS complaint requires a fee (it is completely free)
- Not following up on a filed CPGRAMS grievance or using the appeal option when dissatisfied
- Forgetting to note the acknowledgement/registration number from any official complaint

Myths vs Facts

Myth	Fact
"112 only handles police emergencies"	112 covers police, fire, medical, women's safety, and disaster emergencies
"CPGRAMS filing requires payment"	The government charges no fee to file a grievance on CPGRAMS
"1098 is only for reporting child abuse"	It also assists children in any form of distress or need for protection
"Old numbers like 100 and 101 no longer work"	They remain functional in many areas while being progressively integrated into 112
"The panic button feature only works with the 112 App installed"	The power-button/key-press panic trigger can work at a basic phone level in many ERSS-enabled areas

Do's and Don'ts

Do	Don't
Save 112, 1930, 1098, 181 in your contacts	Don't wait until an emergency to look up numbers
Use 112 for any urgent police/fire/medical need	Don't waste time deciding which old number to call
File formal complaints via CPGRAMS for tracking	Don't rely only on informal, unrecorded complaints
Teach family members the panic-button trick	Don't assume only adults need to know these numbers
Note registration/acknowledgement numbers	Don't discard them before your issue is resolved

Safety Tips

For Emergencies

- Stay calm and clearly state your location and the nature of the emergency
- Use the 112 App's SHOUT feature if nearby help could respond faster than official services
- Keep phones charged and location services enabled for faster emergency response

For Grievances

- Use CPGRAMS for any unresolved government service issue, keeping your registration ID safe
- Use the appeal facility if a resolution is unsatisfactory rather than giving up

For Families

- Practice the panic button trick with children and elderly family members
- Display key emergency numbers visibly at home for quick reference
- Discuss which number applies to which type of emergency as a family exercise

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Practical Checklist

- ☐ Saved 112 (emergency), 1930 (cybercrime), 1098 (child), 181 (women) in my phone
- ☐ Installed the 112 India App and explored its panic/SHOUT features
- ☐ Know my state's disaster management helpline
- ☐ Know how to file a grievance via CPGRAMS
- ☐ Taught family members the power-button panic trick
- ☐ Displayed key emergency numbers at home

Quick Revision Notes

- 112 unifies police (100), fire (101), medical, women's safety, and disaster response nationally
- 1098 is the dedicated child helpline; 181/1091 are women's helplines
- 1930 handles cybercrime/financial fraud; CPGRAMS handles government service grievances
- CPGRAMS is free, tracked by registration ID, with a 21-day resolution target
- The 112 App's SHOUT feature and panic button add extra layers of rapid response

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Key Takeaways

1. In most emergencies, 112 is the single number to remember first
2. Different but related numbers (1098, 181, 1930) exist for specific vulnerable-group and cybercrime concerns

3. CPGRAMS gives every citizen a free, trackable way to escalate unresolved government service issues
4. Preparing family members in advance — saved numbers, panic button knowledge — saves critical time
5. Knowing the right channel for the right situation is itself a form of safety

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Glossary

- **CHILDLINE** — India's 24×7 child helpline, reachable at 1098
- **CPGRAMS** — Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System
- **DARPG** — Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances
- **ERSS** — Emergency Response Support System (112)
- **NDMA** — National Disaster Management Authority
- **PSAP** — Public Safety Answering Point
- **SHOUT** — A 112 App feature alerting nearby volunteers during an emergency

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Frequently Asked Questions

1. What is 112?
India's unified national emergency number covering police, fire, medical, women's safety, and disaster response.

2. When was ERSS-112 launched?
19 February 2019, by the Ministry of Home Affairs.

3. Does 112 replace the old 100, 101, and 108 numbers?
It integrates them into a single number, though legacy numbers may still function in many areas during the transition.

4. What is the SHOUT feature?
A 112 India App feature that alerts nearby registered volunteers and app users during an emergency.

5. How do I trigger a panic alert without opening an app?
By pressing the phone's power button three times quickly, or long-pressing 5/9 on basic phones, in ERSS-enabled areas.

6. What is 1098?
CHILDLINE, India's 24×7 helpline for children in distress or needing protection.

7. What are 181 and 1091?
Dedicated women's helplines for harassment, safety concerns, and domestic violence.

8. What number should I call for financial cyber fraud?
1930, India's dedicated cybercrime helpline.

9. What is CPGRAMS?
The Centralised Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System, for filing grievances against government services.

10. Is there a fee to file a CPGRAMS grievance?
No, filing a grievance on CPGRAMS is completely free.

11. How long does CPGRAMS aim to take to resolve a grievance?
Around 21 days, under current guidelines.

12. Can I track my CPGRAMS complaint?
Yes, using the unique registration ID provided when you file it.

13. What if I'm not satisfied with a CPGRAMS resolution?
You can use the appeal facility within CPGRAMS to escalate further.

14. Who coordinates disaster response in India?
The National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA), alongside state disaster management authorities.

15. Can 112 be used during a natural disaster?
Yes, 112 includes dispatch capability for disaster-related emergencies.

16. Is 112 available across all of India?
Yes, it is operational across all States and Union Territories.

17. What information should I give when calling 112?
Your exact location and a clear description of the emergency.

18. Can children be taught to use 112?
Yes, teaching children the panic-button trick and the number 112 is a recommended family safety practice.

19. Does CPGRAMS handle personal or family disputes?
No — CPGRAMS explicitly excludes personal/family disputes, sub-judice matters, and RTI-related issues.

20. What is a Public Safety Answering Point (PSAP)?
The state-level facility that receives and dispatches 112 emergency signals to the relevant service.

21. Is 1098 only for reporting abuse?
No — it assists children in any situation of distress or need for protection, not abuse alone.

22. Where can I download the 112 India App?
Through official app stores (Google Play/App Store), searching for "112 India."

Suggested Infographics, Flowcharts & Illustrations

(For JanGyan design team — placement suggestions only; no images generated here)

- **"One Number, Every Emergency" 112 unification diagram** → within "Fundamental Concepts"
- **Emergency numbers quick-reference card (112/1930/1098/181)** → near "Practical Checklist"
- **112 panic button trigger visual (power button x3)** → within "Step-by-Step Understanding"
- **CPGRAMS grievance flow (File → Track → Appeal)** → within "Step-by-Step Understanding"
- **Emergency vs Grievance decision flowchart** → within "Fundamental Concepts"

Official References

- Ministry of Home Affairs — Emergency Response Support System (ERSS-112) documentation
- Department of Administrative Reforms and Public Grievances (DARPG) — CPGRAMS guidelines and statistics
- National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) — disaster response framework
- Disaster Management Act, 2005

- Press Information Bureau (PIB), Government of India — CPGRAMS and ERSS press releases

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Official Government Website Links

- 112 India (ERSS): **https://112.gov.in**
- CPGRAMS: **https://pgportal.gov.in**
- National Disaster Management Authority: **https://ndma.gov.in**
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal: **https://cybercrime.gov.in**
- India.gov.in (National Portal): **https://www.india.gov.in**

Key Helplines: Emergency: **112** | Cybercrime: **1930** | Child: **1098** | Women: **181 / 1091**

Conclusion

In an emergency, the time spent searching for the right number is time you don't have. India's unified 112 system, alongside dedicated helplines for children, women, cybercrime, and grievances, means help is never more than a single, memorable number away — as long as you know it in advance.

This is the next step in your Government Services & Citizen Rights journey with JanGyan. Stay prepared, stay informed, and remember: **save the numbers today, so you never have to search for them in a crisis.**

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Module 7 of the Government Services & Citizen Rights Category